

PROGRAM ASSESSMENT PLAN

Program information

- **Program name:** Master of Design (MDes)
- **CIM code:** MDS-IDDG
- **CIM link:** <https://bulletinnext.iit.edu/programadmin/>
- **Academic Unit:** Institute of Design
- **Program assessment coordinator:** Matt Mayfield, mayfield@id.iit.edu
- **Effective date of plan:** Fall 2024

Learning Objectives (LO)

- 1. Develop actionable and constructive insight into a given design problem**
 - a. Able to organize analysis, principles, and implications
 - b. Able to develop model(s) of understanding
 - c. Able to share critical and constructive point(s) of view
- 2. Advocate for human and humanity-centric principles for a given design problem**
 - a. Able to present comprehensive considerations
 - b. Able to identify appropriate guiding principles
 - c. Able to share identified paradoxes & tradeoffs to consider
- 3. Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals**
 - a. Able to demonstrate tangible ideas, concepts, and insights
 - b. Able to list provocations, hypotheses, and/or questions to consider
 - c. Able to share experimental results and implications
- 4. Communicate and defend design proposals in a continuously constructive manner**
 - a. Able to develop thoughtful and considered evaluations
 - b. Able to revise assumptions, principles, and metrics
 - c. Able to articulate next steps or actions to take
- 5. Bring a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems**
 - a. Able to articulate desired future states of a system(s)
 - b. Able to illustrate leverage points of a system(s)
 - c. Able to identify adaptive solutions, strategies, or interventions
- 6. Lead multidisciplinary teamwork towards actionable outcomes**
 - a. Able to facilitate across different disciplines/ perspectives involved
 - b. Able to articulate decisions and appropriate actions

Curriculum Map

	Goal 1: Develop actionable and constructive insight into a given design problem	Goal 2: Advocate for human and humanity-centric principles for a given design problem	Goal 3: Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals	Goal 4: Communicate and defend design proposals in a continuously constructive manner	Goal 5: Bring a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems	Goal 6: Lead multi-disciplinary teamwork towards actionable outcomes
IDN 501 Communication Systems			A	X		
IDN 503 Embodied Design			A	X		
IDN 505 Digital Media			A	X		
IDN 508 Principles and Methods of User Research	A	D				
IDN 566 Strategic Communication		X	X	A		A
IDN 571 Introduction to Systems Theory					A	X
IDX 508 Modes of Human Experience	D	A				
IDX 542 Analysis + Synthesis	I			I	I	A
IDX 550 Building & Understanding Context	A			D	D	D

X = Contribute, I = Introduce, D = Development, A = Assessed

Assessment Schedule

Objectives/goals are assessed two per year. This allows us to review each goal twice within a nine-year period. Each assessment will also comment on the implementation of improvement plans from the prior year's assessment.

Academic year 2022/2023

Goal 2: Advocate for human and humanity-centric principles for a given design problem

Goal 6: Lead multidisciplinary teamwork towards actionable outcomes

Academic year 2023/2024

Goal 1: Develop actionable and constructive insight into a given design problem

Goal 4: Communicate and defend design proposals in a continuously constructive manner

Academic year 2024/2025

Goal 3: Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals

Goal 5: Bring a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems

Academic year 2025/2026

Goal 2: Advocate for human and humanity-centric principles for a given design problem

Goal 6: Lead multidisciplinary teamwork towards actionable outcomes

Academic year 2026/2027

Goal 1: Develop actionable and constructive insight into a given design problem

Goal 4: Communicate and defend design proposals in a continuously constructive manner

Assessment Process

Objectives and goals are assessed typically using final presentations or project summaries at the end of each course. Rubrics for assessment will be reflected in the assessment reports. Affected faculty will provide evidence at the end of each semester (course).

Ideally, select faculty will review submissions over the summer break to provide enough time to compile the assessment report and gather feedback from faculty and dean prior to university submission deadline on Oct 15.

All student submissions to every course identified for assessment in the curriculum map will be archived in the universities current LMS or protected school cloud drive. Specific location indicated on each assessment report.

Communication Plan

Assessment reports will be shared with all full-time faculty, dean, and associate dean typically over the winter break, but possibly earlier depending on the issues identified in the report. Specific and prioritized issues to be addressed will be shared and discussed during one or more of the weekly faculty meetings as well.

Continuous Improvement, CI, Plan

Improvement plans will be introduced to the faculty as soon as possible once identified. Depending on the issue, improvement will be either directed to appropriate and specific faculty/courses or shared with the full faculty to address in each of their courses school wide.

Improvements will be tracked via weekly faculty meetings (academic reflections are a part of every faculty meeting). And additional tracking will be done via the annual assessment reports.